

Typeface Portrait: Note the Color-Coded Sections

"Building My Own Compass"



CATEGORY 1: Traits I Aspire to Develop

One trait I hope to cultivate is **resilience**. When my soccer team lost our championship game last spring, I realized how much I tend to shut down after setbacks. I want to face failure without quitting, because life won't always go the way I plan.

Another trait is **curiosity**. I admire people who keep asking "why" even when they already know a lot. My grandpa—an amateur astronomer—still looks up at the sky like it's his first time. I want to approach books, science, and even disagreements that way.

I also want to develop **empathy**. I've seen friendships break over small misunderstandings. Learning to pause, listen, and imagine another person's feelings feels like a kind of quiet power.

Finally, **discipline** matters to me. I've struggled with procrastination, especially when assignments pile up. Building better habits—like breaking tasks into smaller steps—will help me move from dreaming about goals to actually meeting them.



CATEGORY 2: Priorities, Goals & Vision

My biggest priority right now is **finishing high school strong** while keeping balance in my life. Academics matter, but so does my mental health and my relationships.

A specific goal I set last semester was to raise my essay scores by one full level on the rubric. I made a plan: meet with my teacher during office hours once a month, swap drafts with a classmate for feedback, and block out two study sessions each week. A strategy that worked was using a "two-pass" revision—first fixing big-picture organization, then tackling sentence-level details.

Long term, I picture myself studying environmental science or policy. My priority is to work toward a future where my voice matters in conversations about climate change. Even small steps—like joining the campus Green Club or volunteering for creek cleanups—make me feel part of something bigger.

CATEGORY 3: Reader, Writer, Thinker

When I read something confusing, I usually reread the section, then look for a summary or discussion online. But I've learned that wrestling with difficult texts often reveals new insights—I noticed this when annotating “Dover Beach” last week and realizing the “Sea of Faith” metaphor connected to modern uncertainties.

I write best when I have a strong emotional connection to the topic. My free-write about my grandmother's garden flowed effortlessly compared to a lab report. To organize my thoughts, I like using sticky notes on my desk to physically move ideas around before drafting.

As a thinker, I'm starting to recognize how language shapes perspective. Watching a debate on climate policy showed me that the same data can be framed as urgency or alarmism depending on the words chosen. I want to use language responsibly—to inform, persuade, and sometimes comfort.

This self-portrait feels like building a compass: resilience keeps me steady, curiosity points me outward, empathy pulls me toward others, and discipline keeps me on course. My goals and priorities aren't fixed points—they'll shift as I grow—but this map will help me navigate the world and use language to move hearts and minds.

Typeface Portrait

- Canvas Size: Letter (8.5 × 11) vertical. Background: pale gradient.
- Largest Words (Traits): “Resilience,” “Curiosity,” “Empathy,” “Discipline” (bold, in a clean sans-serif like Montserrat, arranged in a circular shape around a central silhouette of a compass).
- Medium Words (Priorities & Goals): “Environmental Science,” “Balance,” “Green Club,” “Voice in Climate Policy,” “Revision Strategy,” “Relationships” (placed between the large words, slightly smaller font, varying angles).
- Smallest Words (Reader/Writer/Thinker): “Annotation,” “Sticky Notes,” “Dover Beach,” “Critical Thinking,” “Language Shapes Perspective,” “Two-Pass Revision”.
- Student name and date at bottom corner in a small italic font.





